Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR RESIDENCY PROGRESS FRAMEWORK

Structured developmental pathway for progressing tutors from guided participation to independent teaching within the Jothi Tutor Academy

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Purpose of the Document

This document defines the residency progress framework used within the Jothi Tutor Academy. Its purpose is to describe the staged pathway through which tutors develop from early guided exposure to greater independence in teaching.

The residency framework exists to ensure that tutor development is gradual, structured, and evidence-aware. Tutors are not expected to become strong teachers by subject knowledge alone or by being placed too quickly into unsupported teaching. They are developed through a sequence of observation, supported practice, feedback, increasing responsibility, and readiness-based progression.

This document therefore provides the developmental pathway within which reflection, mentor observation, competency development, and eventual certification can take place coherently.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for:

- tutors progressing through the Jothi Tutor Academy
- mentors overseeing tutor development and readiness
- academy leadership reviewing progression, support, and certification readiness

Related JTA Documents

- JTD01 — Tutor Competency Framework
- JTD02 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard
- JTD06 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard
- JTS01 — Lesson Delivery Standard

1. Purpose of the Residency Model

The residency model provides the academy with a structured way to develop tutors over time. Its purpose is to ensure that tutors gain practical teaching capability through increasing levels of participation rather than through abrupt transition into independent teaching.

A staged model matters because good tutoring requires more than content knowledge. Tutors must learn how to explain clearly, ask diagnostic questions, monitor student thinking, correct misconceptions, maintain lesson flow, and teach with professional consistency. These capabilities are better developed through guided progression than through trial and error alone.

The residency model therefore protects both tutor development and teaching quality.

2. Principles of the Residency Framework

The residency framework is guided by the following principles:

- development should be gradual rather than rushed
- progression should be based on evidence of readiness
- mentors should play an active developmental role
- supported practice should come before independent responsibility
- reflection and observation should strengthen learning from experience
- residency progression and final certification should remain related but distinct

These principles help ensure that the pathway remains developmental rather than merely administrative.

3. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

The residency framework sits within the wider JTA system and works alongside several other documents.

- **JTD01** defines the competencies tutors are expected to develop.
- **JTD02** supports tutor reflection during progression.

- **JTD04** supports mentor observation and developmental feedback.
- **JTD06** defines how final certification decisions are made.
- **JTS01** defines what effective lesson delivery should look like in practice.

The residency framework does not replace these documents. It provides the developmental pathway within which they operate.

4. Stages of the Tutor Residency

The residency pathway is organised into four main stages:

- Stage 1 — Observation
- Stage 2 — Co-Teaching
- Stage 3 — Lead Teaching
- Stage 4 — Independent Teaching

These stages describe increasing levels of teaching responsibility. They should not be treated as fixed time blocks that every tutor passes through at exactly the same speed. Tutors progress when they are ready, based on evidence and mentor judgement.

5. Stage 1 — Observation

In the observation stage, the tutor watches lessons delivered by a mentor or experienced tutor in order to understand how effective teaching is carried out within the Jothi model.

The purpose of this stage is not passive watching alone. It is to help the tutor begin noticing:

- how concepts are explained
- how diagnostic questions are used
- how student thinking is monitored
- how misconceptions are corrected
- how lessons are structured and paced
- how professional conduct appears in live teaching

Observation helps create early instructional awareness before the tutor is asked to lead teaching.

Indicators of productive observation

A tutor in this stage is beginning to:

- notice teaching structure more clearly
- understand the logic of the 4T model in live lessons
- identify examples of strong explanation and questioning
- reflect on what makes a lesson effective

6. Stage 2 — Co-Teaching

In the co-teaching stage, the tutor begins taking an active role in lesson delivery while still working alongside a mentor or experienced tutor.

This stage may include:

- explaining part of a lesson
- asking selected questions
- guiding a small section of student work
- responding to student answers under mentor support
- practising board work or explanation in a live context

The purpose of co-teaching is to move the tutor from observation into supported instructional action.

Developmental value of co-teaching

Co-teaching allows the tutor to begin practising core teaching moves while still benefiting from live support, correction, and modelling. It reduces the risk of early overwhelm and allows feedback to be closely tied to real teaching attempts.

Indicators of readiness within co-teaching

A tutor in this stage is beginning to:

- explain short sections with reasonable clarity
- ask useful questions with mentor guidance
- respond to students more confidently
- remain composed while participating in live teaching
- reflect on what went well and what needs improvement

7. Stage 3 — Lead Teaching

In the lead teaching stage, the tutor begins taking primary responsibility for lesson delivery while the mentor observes and provides developmental feedback.

This stage is a major shift because the tutor is no longer contributing only in parts. The tutor is now expected to sustain lesson flow, maintain clarity, and respond to student thinking across a larger part of the lesson or the whole lesson.

The purpose of this stage is to test and strengthen the tutor's ability to teach with greater independence while still remaining under structured observation.

Areas of focus in lead teaching

At this stage, the academy is likely to pay close attention to whether the tutor can:

- explain concepts clearly and coherently
- ask diagnostic questions that reveal real understanding
- monitor how the student is thinking
- correct misunderstanding effectively
- maintain a structured and purposeful lesson
- respond to difficulty without losing clarity or control

Developmental significance

This stage often generates the strongest evidence for competency development because the tutor's teaching is more visible as a whole, not only in fragments.

8. Stage 4 — Independent Teaching

In the independent teaching stage, the tutor is able to teach lessons without continuous live support, while still remaining part of the wider development and quality system of the academy.

Independent teaching does not mean development has ended. It means the tutor can now carry lesson responsibility with sufficient reliability to operate more autonomously.

At this stage, the tutor is expected to show:

- greater consistency across lessons
- stronger instructional judgement
- clearer control of lesson structure and pacing
- more dependable professional conduct
- ability to work within academy standards without constant intervention

Periodic observation, feedback, and review may still continue where appropriate.

9. Progression Through the Residency

Progression from one stage to the next should be based on readiness rather than elapsed time alone.

Important progression evidence may include:

- mentor observation of live teaching
- tutor reflection showing growing awareness
- demonstration of relevant competencies
- ability to take on greater responsibility without major instability
- consistency rather than isolated success

A tutor may move more quickly in some areas and more slowly in others. The framework should allow for developmental variation without losing standards.

10. Role of Reflection in Residency Progress

Reflection supports residency progression by helping tutors learn from each stage of development.

During residency, reflection helps tutors:

- notice what they are beginning to understand about teaching
- recognise where they remain uncertain
- identify realistic next steps
- become less passive in receiving mentor feedback

Reflection does not replace mentor judgement, but it strengthens developmental maturity and self-awareness.

11. Role of Mentor Observation in Residency Progress

Mentor observation is central to the residency model because progression decisions should be informed by real teaching evidence.

Mentors support progression by:

- observing the tutor in live teaching situations
- identifying strengths and weaknesses clearly
- providing focused feedback
- judging whether the tutor is ready for greater responsibility
- recognising evidence of competency development over time

Without observation, residency progression risks becoming based on assumption or confidence rather than evidence.

12. Relationship Between Residency and Competency Development

Residency stages describe the tutor’s position in the developmental pathway. Competencies describe what the tutor is able to do within that pathway.

These two ideas are closely linked, but they are not identical.

A tutor may be in a later residency stage while still needing development in a particular competency. Equally, a tutor may demonstrate a strong competency early without yet being ready for full independent teaching.

For this reason, residency progression should be informed by competency evidence, but not reduced to simple stage labels.

13. Relationship Between Residency Completion and Certification

Residency progression and certification are closely related, but they should not be treated as the same decision.

- **Residency progression** concerns developmental readiness for increased teaching responsibility.
- **Certification** concerns formal approval for independent teaching at the required academy standard.

A tutor may complete the main residency pathway and still require final review before certification is granted. This distinction helps preserve the seriousness of certification and prevents the pathway from becoming automatic.

14. Common Residency Risks

The following risks should be actively avoided within the residency process:

- moving tutors into independent teaching too quickly
- confusing confidence with competence
- allowing progression without enough observed evidence
- treating residency stages as fixed time periods rather than readiness stages
- giving feedback that is too vague to support growth
- separating reflection, observation, and competency development from the actual pathway

These risks weaken both tutor development and teaching quality.

15. What Mentors and Leaders Should Look For

When reviewing residency progression, mentors and academy leaders should look for evidence that the tutor is:

- becoming more instructionally clear
- showing stronger responsiveness to student thinking
- improving through feedback rather than repeating the same errors
- ready for greater teaching responsibility
- developing professional reliability as well as teaching skill

Progression decisions should be developmental, fair, and evidence-aware.

16. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

This framework supports the wider JTA system by giving tutor development a visible pathway. It helps connect philosophy, teaching standards, live coaching, competency evidence, and certification into one coherent progression structure.

Without the residency framework, the academy would still have standards and competencies, but it would have a weaker developmental route through which tutors move toward readiness.

The residency model therefore gives shape to tutor development across the academy.

17. Conclusion

The Tutor Residency Progress Framework provides the Jothi Tutor Academy with a structured developmental pathway from observation to independent teaching. Its value lies in making progression gradual, supported, and evidence-aware rather than informal or rushed.

This framework exists to ensure that tutors grow through meaningful practice, mentor guidance, and increasing instructional responsibility, while preserving the academy's teaching standards and developmental integrity.